

2.00 West Berkshire Mencap Conditional Jockeys' Handicap Hurdle**£12,000 Total Race Value** **SKY****2m41/2f**

For 4yo + Rated 0-110 (also open to such horses rated 111 and 112 - see Standard Conditions) Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after February 14th, each hurdle won 7lb **Penalty value 1st** £6,337.20 **2nd** £2,916 **3rd** £1,458 **4th** £729.60 **5th** £363.60

GD-SFT

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
 Guchen 6 12-2t ⁺	K Bailey & M Nicholls	Aamilah Aswat (10)	4-1	112	100	113
Scored under Aamilah Aswat at Kempton (2m5f, good to soft) this month, drawing clear of the others with a progressive rival; 6lb higher here but, after only eight hurdle runs, further progress is possible; tongue-tie added.						
 Calme Olympien 7 12-2t	T Vaughan	Alex Chadwick	14-1	112	76	107
Ex-French 7yo who won three-runner Ffos Las maiden (2m4f, good) on British debut in October and didn't run badly when last of four finishers in Sandown handicap (2m4f, heavy) last month, albeit finishing tired; back on a less testing surface here; no surprise if he features.						
 Our Dylan 10 11-13	Mrs K Woollacott	Callum Pritchard	7-1	109	99	104
In-form 10yo who has won two of his last three; raised another 4lb since scoring under a good 7lb claimer at Taunton (2m3f, heavy) this month, though, and may find younger rivals better handicapped here.						
 Karma Police 6 11-13	H Derham	Ben Sutton	4-1	109	95	103
Irish point winner who posted his most encouraging of three runs over hurdles when third in Ffos Las (2m4f, heavy) in January latest; unraced on ground faster than soft but should have more improvement to come in handicaps.						
 Caliach Point 6 11-13t	B Pauling	Beau Morgan (3)	16-1	109	71	104
Belied 40-1 odds when second in Doncaster novice (2m, soft) in November but was no threat to the easy winner there and tailed off next time; back up in trip for handicap debut; opening mark demands improvement.						
 Super Freddie 5 11-13	N & W Twiston-Davies	Toby McCain-Mitchell (3)	12-1	109	75	106
Placed over 2m on first two hurdling starts but dropped out rather tamely after making the running on handicap debut at Haydock (2m3f, good to soft) in December and arrives here with a point to prove.						
 Hackney Hill 8 11-13t ⁺	P Nicholls	Jay Tidball (3)	10-1	109	35	108
Soundly beaten in three Irish maiden hurdles (2m-2m4f) for Edward O'Grady in 2024 and makes stable/handicap debut after a 425-day absence; however, he's hugely unexposed and will need to be taken very seriously if strong in the betting; tongue-tie added.						
 Activist 7 11-11tv	D Pipe	Rian Corcoran (6)	7-1	107	106	113
Four-time hurdle winner; bounced back from a poor run when second at Plumpton (2m4f, soft; tongue-tie refitted) this month and new jockey Rian Corcoran claims a useful 6lb; shortlisted.						
 Couldntmakeitup 6 11-8t	J Nash (IRE)	Gavin Brouder (3)	7-1	104	67	109
Irish raider; 0-10 over hurdles but gave a pretty good account when third at Punchestown (2m, soft to heavy) last month and could be better suited by today's trip-and-ground combination; might be the answer.						
 El Curamach 8 11-6t	R Potter	Dylan Johnston	20-1	102	105	108
Justified odds-on favouritism in run-of-the-mill Warwick maiden (2m, good) in May 2024 but this handicap debut comes after a mammoth absence and he'll be of interest only if lively in the betting.						
 Boston Savr 5 11-2p ⁺	J & A J O'Neill	Benjamin Macey (3)	20-1	98	85	107
Did not get competitive in three maiden/novice hurdles (1m7f-2m) in December/January and does not look well treated for this handicap debut, but combination of new trip and first-time cheekpieces may enable improvement.						
 Osterberg 6 11-2	M Keighley	Harry Atkins (3)	14-1	98	97	108
Displayed improvement to score on heavy ground at Ffos Las (2m6f) last month but raced too freely and was a disappointing favourite when well-held third at Lingfield (2m7f, heavy) three weeks ago; others appeal more.						
 No Mean Feat 7 10-2	S Hodgson	Paddy Hanlon	33-1	84	79	104
Returned from long absence with a heavy defeat in small field at Fontwell on Boxing Day and is now 0-12 over hurdles; 2lb wrong here and has a lot more to prove than some of these.						

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT Recent Kempton winner **Guchen** (second choice) can go well again, while **Activist** benefits from Rian Corcoran's useful 6lb claim and handicap debutant **Karma Police** is open to more improvement. However, the suggestion is Irish raider **COULDNTMAKEITUP**, who was placed over 2m at Punchestown last month and might be better suited by today's longer trip.[Chris Wilson]

2.30 BetVictor Simple Things Juvenile Hurdle (Novices' Championship Hurdle Series Qualifier) (GBB Race)
£15,000 Total Race Value SKY
2m1/2f
For 4yo Weights 11st Penalties a winner of a Class 3 to Class 5 hurdle 6lb; of 2 hurdles or of a Class 1 or Class 2 hurdle 10lb Penalty value 1st £8,169 2nd £3,763.50 3rd £1,881 4th £942
GD-SFT

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
 Innamorato 4 11-6p	P Nicholls	Harry Cobden	7-2	117	81	111
Made a quiet start for this yard but he showed plenty of ability in France and came good in a heavy-ground maiden at Taunton (2m3f); it's unlikely that he needs that sort of ground, and he could progress further; penalised.						
 Mojito Des Mottes 4 11-6t	B Pauling	Ben Jones	4-1	120	63	107
A bit underwhelming in his two British runs (good/good to soft) and again he's burdened with a penalty for his win in France; looks very flattered by a BHA mark of 120 but it will be disappointing if he can't do better for his powerful connections.						
 Bowling Shane 4 11-0	C Boulton-Brooks	Richard Patrick	33-1	-	-	-
Best of his four Flat runs was a fourth of nine on the AW (1m4f novice; fair form) when beaten under 5l; has some ability and stable had a recent juvenile hurdle winner, but he's not the obvious answer.						
 Ettore 4 11-0	N Henderson	Nico de Boinville	4-1	-	-	-
Well-bred colt but 0-4 in these colours for Roger Varian and the latest third in a 1m novice at Windsor in August is nothing to shout about; has joined a leading yard for jumps action but that's the principal positive.						
 Laplander 4 11-0	T Ward	Dylan Johnston	50-1	-	90	99
Maiden who had plenty of chances on the Flat and has been beaten 22l and 64l in two races over hurdles at this track; admittedly, he was never going to mix it with Sober Glory last time, but probably one for handicaps.						
 Love You Back 4 11-0	G & J Moore	Caoilin Quinn	5-2	-	107	107
No great shakes on the Flat (1-11) but he did win his final run in that scene over 1m4f at Brighton in September (good to firm; also runner-up on soft); failed favourite backers when second on hurdling debut (Warwick; 2m, good) but the winner has since progressed to better things; absent since November but his yard has won two of the last four renewals of this; player.						
 Mistral St Georges 4 11-0	Ms G Nicholls	Finn Lambert (3)	50-1	-	-	-
Half-brother to winners Georges Saint (2m3f-2m5f chase) and Kobalt St Georges (2m1f-2m5f hurdle); dam once-raced half-sister to useful 2m hurdle/chase winner Bon Papa; a watching brief is probably best.						
 Rogue Justice 4 11-0p	J Jones	Sean Bowen	8-1	-	-	-
Back from a break to get off the mark on the Flat last month (sixth attempt), albeit in a low-grade 2m handicap on the AW; has the stamina for hurdling and Sean Bowen is booked, but others are still preferred.						
 Cecilia Star 4 10-7	Mrs L Wadham	Tom Cannon	13-2	-	91	109
Lightly raced for Michael Bell but won a 1m2f AW maiden and was close up in a Goodwood handicap; that Flat form is the best on show here and it was an encouraging start over hurdles when not beaten far in a maiden for mares at Kempton (staying on; good to soft); considered.						

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT **Innamorato** and **Mojito Des Mottes** could be vulnerable with their penalties unless either can take a step forward. **Love You Back** represents a yard with a good record in this race and his second at Warwick reads better now, but the filly **CECILIA STAR** is preferred. She was the best of these on the Flat despite having only four races and she had an encouraging first run over hurdles at Kempton. [Alistair Jones]

3.00 OLBG "Chasing Excellence" Novices' Chase (GBB Race)**£17,500 Total Race Value** **SKY****2m71/2f**

For 5yo+ which have not won more than one chase **Weights** 5yo 10st 10lb; 6yo+ 11st 2lb **Penalties** a winner of a chase 6lb; Excluding the winner, the Official BHA Rating of any horse taking part in this race will not be increased due to performance in this race, provided the horse has had at least four prior completed runs over chases and/or hurdles combined **Penalty value** 1st £9,241.75 2nd £4,252.50 3rd £2,126.25 4th £1,064 5th £530.25

GD-SFT

		Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
	Miami Magic 7 11-8	S Edmunds	Charlie Hammond	4-6	142	141	155
Fine on good and soft ground; Grade 1 placed over hurdles and this Cheltenham chase winner did well to finish within 7l of the smart Sixmilebridge in the Grade 1 Scilly Isles at Sandown (2m4f) as he can jump a lot better than he did that day on soft ground; every chance that he'll be able to give weight and a beating to these, provided he stays this longer trip.							
	Elysian Knight 7 11-2	N Mulholland	Sean Bowen	10-1	123	89	136
Dual hurdle winner; pulled up on chase debut and again wasn't foot-perfect over his fences when runner-up at Musselburgh (2m4f, good to soft; had subsequent Listed winner behind); should win again sooner or later but today's terms are not favourable.							
	Thank You Ma'Am 7 11-2p	Ms G Nicholls	Miss Olive Nicholls (5)	12-1	126	80	135
Useful winning hurdler who stays this far and seems able on most ground; recent remote third on chase debut was after a lengthy break and in useful company; might well be all the sharper here but faces a tricky task at the weights.							
	Wyenot 7 11-1w	H Daly	Sam Twiston-Davies	3-1	135	148	147
Five-time hurdle winner with a good strike-rate, one she enhanced when prevailing in a classy small-field beginners' chase at Ludlow (3m, good); remote last of three in a Listed chase for mares at Warwick where soft ground was no good to her (fine on good to soft); has since had wind surgery and retains potential as a chaser.							
	That's Nice 6 10-9	N Henderson	Nico de Boinville	15-2	119	118	131
Irish pointer who went 2-3 in novice hurdles; it's been a quiet start as a chaser (2m3f handicaps) and she didn't really take a cut at her fences last time at Doncaster (in first-time cheekpieces, now removed); now has a bit to prove but her hurdling form has to be respected.							

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT All things considered, **MIAMI MAGIC** ran very well in the Group 1 Scilly Isles and there's every chance that he'll jump better than at Sandown now that he is back on ground that won't be so soft. **Wyenot** is the obvious danger on these terms, and when bearing in mind that she's an assured stayer. The ground would have been too soft for her last time at Warwick and she's since undergone a wind operation. [Alistair Jones]

3.35 BetVictor Watch Weekend Winners "National Hunt" Novices'**Hurdle (GBB Race)****£15,000 Total Race Value SKY****2m41/2f**

For 5yo+ which have not run in a flat race **Weights** 11st **Penalties** a winner of a Class 3 to Class 5 hurdle 6lb; of 2 hurdles or of a Class 1 or Class 2 hurdle 10lb **Penalty value** 1st £8,169 2nd £3,763.50 3rd £1,881 4th £942

GD-SFT

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
 Talk To The Man 6 11-6	P Nicholls	Harry Cobden	11-8	-	116	138
Paul Nicholls has won three of the last five runnings of this race; this Irish point winner (good to yielding) left his bumper form behind when comfortably accounting for his penalised market rival in a 2m3f novice at Taunton (heavy); it's difficult to know how good he might be and he commands considerable respect.						
 The Big Clubman 6 11-6	P Nolan (IRE)	Sean O'Keeffe	5-6	132	125	136
Irish challenger with an Albert Bartlett entry at Cheltenham; won maiden at Wexford on good ground and stayed on well from off pace to be second in a 2m4f Grade 3 at Navan (heavy); latest run in a Grade 2 wasn't so clever, but that was over 2m7f and it turned into a sprint finish; nice prospect.						
 Agent Argyle 6 11-0	R Phillips	Finn Lambert (3)	100-1	-	94	98
Irish point winner; shaped okay behind a smart winner in a bumper at Wetherby but still went off at 80-1 for hurdle debut at Doncaster and ended up tailed off.						
 Big Bert 6 11-0	J Owen	Sean Bowen	16-1	-	63	107
Point winner and runner-up in a bumper and a maiden hurdle, though was beaten 16l on that latter occasion and inherited second place; brought down at the first last time; has to raise his game against this opposition.						
 Buddy Holly 5 11-0	N Henderson	Nico de Boinville	12-1	-	110	124
Looked to have a future when shaping well in an Irish bumper (good to yielding) and a C&D novice (soft); Ffos Las last time was a backward step but heavy ground there doesn't suit all horses; remains of interest.						
 Laurier Des Obeaux 5 11-0	G & J Moore	Caoilin Quinn	20-1	-	91	116
Made an encouraging start over hurdles at Lingfield (2m3f, good to soft) and it was a better race when beaten 18l here in December; should improve, but it's needed.						
 Mulinas 7 11-0	P Nicholls	Sam Twiston-Davies	33-1	-	32	94
Beat Potters Charm in an Irish point; two bumper runs were okay but he has struggled in two maiden hurdles following a long absence; looks the clear stable second string.						

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT Irish raider **The Big Clubman** brings Graded form and it's clear that he failed to give his true running last time. However, **TALK TO THE MAN** posted an eye-catching RPR when winning as he liked at Taunton and this scopey 6yo possesses considerable potential. **Buddy Holly** had shaped well before getting stuck in the mud at Ffos Las. [Alistair Jones]

4.03 Highclere Horse Feeds Oataalin Handicap Chase (For The Geoffrey Gilbey Trophy) (GBB Race)
£20,000 Total Race Value **SKY**
2m1/2f
For 5yo+ **Rated** 0-130 (also open to such horses rated 131 and 132 - see Standard Conditions) **Weights raised** 1lb **Minimum weight** 10-2 **Penalties** after February 14th, each chase won 7lb **Penalty value** **1st** £10,562 **2nd** £4,860 **3rd** £2,430 **4th** £1,216 **5th** £606

GD-SFT

		Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
	Kotmask 8 12-0p	G & J Moore	Caoilin Quinn	8-1	129	129	137
Resurgent in first-time blinkers when second to an improver at Sandown in January (good; fine on soft) and fell midrace back there last time; it's surprising to see cheekpieces back on (beaten 10l in December when tried in them once before) but he has a big effort in him off this mark.							
	Hardy Du Seuil 9 11-11p	J Snowden	Isabelle Ryder (5)	9-2	126	110	134
Won over hurdles in November and has done well on his belated return to fences, following his fourth at Haydock with a near miss at Carlisle (2m, good to soft); Isabelle Ryder again claims her 5lb and this 9yo is up 3lb in future.							
	Daytime Dreaming 6 11-10	T Ellis	Jack Andrews	15-8	125	109	133
Left clear when beating an exposed veteran at Southwell (2m, good to soft) but this 6yo hasn't had much racing over hurdles or fences so he's probably on the upgrade; an 8lb rise might not be the end of the world.							
	Pure Carbon 7 11-4	H Derham	Brendan Powell	2-1	119	123	133
Two wins and a second to show from his completed starts over fences and he went up only 4lb for the Musselburgh success a month ago (2m, good to soft); this is only his 11th career start, so firmly in calculations.							
	Rath Gaul Hill 8 11-1tp	S Drinkwater	Sam Twiston-Davies	12-1	116	122	136
Returning from an absence when edging home in this 12 months ago off 2lb higher; his penultimate effort (here in first-time cheekpieces) was respectable and it's perhaps best to forget Sandown last time when his best form has been on left-handed tracks; respected.							
	First Angel 10 10-7	M Keighley	Sean Bowen	8-1	108	125	131
Sean Bowen was also aboard when this 10yo made it 3-10 over fences at Taunton 13 months ago (2m, good to soft) on second run back from 478 days off; he needed the first and that may again be the case here, after 405 days off, but he's well handicapped.							

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT Tricky, with none of the six dismissed with any confidence. **DAYTIME DREAMING** perhaps has the most upside with him being so lightly raced and he's preferred over **Pure Carbon** who has hit the ground running over fences. Last year's winner **Rath Gaul Hill** probably has to go left handed so his Sandown blip last time is readily forgiven.[Alistair Jones]

4.43 Cheltenham Specials Made Simple At BetVictor Handicap Hurdle
(Challenger Stayers Hurdle Series Qual)
£17,500 Total Race Value **SKY**
3m1/2f
For 5yo+ Rated 0-130 (also open to such horses rated 131 and 132 - see Standard Conditions)
Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after
February 14th, each hurdle won 7lb Penalty value 1st £9,241.75 2nd £4,252.50 3rd £2,126.25 4th £1,064 5th £530.25
GD-SFT

	Trainer	Jockey	SP	OR	TS	RPR
	Tiny Tetley 8 12-2 Won four times over hurdles last season (2m7f-3m) but chasing didn't go to plan in the autumn and he was soundly beaten when back over hurdles on Boxing Day; needs to get career back on track.	P Hobbs & J White Callum Pritchard (3)	16-1	132	128	131
	Peacenik 7 11-13 Low-mileage 7yo who left low-key seasonal debut behind when scoring by just over 5l at Doncaster (2m3f, good to soft) in December and again ran well when placed here (2m4f, good) later that month; open to improvement on first attempt at 3m; must be considered seriously.	K Price Gavin Sheehan	11-2	129	115	130
	Big City Roller 8 11-9p 2-3 over fences this season, with both wins gained in four-runner 2m4f races on heavy ground (cheekpieces added last time); faces a different test on this return to hurdling but could have untapped potential over 3m.	C Longsdon Lilly Pinchin	6-1	125	-	-
	Benign Dictator 9 11-8p 3-15 over hurdles, latest win at Warwick (3m2f, good to soft) on New Year's Eve; below form on latest outing, though, and needs to bounce back with career-best effort here; cheekpieces (absent this term) are refitted.	O Murphy Sean Bowen	8-1	124	125	133
	Magical King 7 11-6p Consistent over hurdles last season, with best effort a C&D second (soft) just over a year ago; disappointing over fences this term (three attempts; blinkers tried last time) and this switch back to hurdling needs to rekindle his enthusiasm; usual cheekpieces back on today.	S Edmunds Charlie Hammond	20-1	122	-	131
	Champagne Twist 8 11-4p Very promising novice during 2023-24 season but generally very disappointing over last two campaigns; pulled up on last three chase/hurdle runs (cheekpieces added last time); big leap of faith required to support him.	B Pauling Elliott England (7)	25-1	120	-	-
	Jalisco Star 8 11-3t 2-4 since returned to hurdling in the autumn, the latter win gained in four-runner mares' race at Chepstow (2m7f, soft) a fortnight ago; evidently in very good nick but has quite a bit more on her plate here.	Laura Horsfall Kevin Brogan	7-1	119	118	130
	Fierce Warrior 7 11-2 Made good start to chasing career in November, notably when winning at Doncaster (3m2f, soft); ran as though something was amiss there in December but has been given a two-month break and has possibilities if back on song for this hurdle return.	N Henderson Nico de Boinville	8-1	118	-	128
	Kruger Park 8 11-2t Good fourth over C&D (soft) in November and outstayed next-time-out winner Jalisco Star when scoring at Fontwell (3m2f, good to soft) on Boxing Day; still on workable mark after latest 2lb rise; likely contender again.	P Nicholls Jay Tidball (5)	5-1	118	122	134
	Call Me Legend 6 11-0 Improving novice who bids to complete a hat-trick after handicap wins at Exeter (2m7f, good to soft) and Wincanton (3m, heavy) this year; moves up in grade but still needs to be taken very seriously.	P Hobbs & J White Mr Jack Stenhouse (7)	11-4	116	126	132

SPOTLIGHT VERDICT **Call Me Legend** (second choice) is respected in his bid for a third win in a row, while **Kruger Park** was nudged up only 2lb for his hard-fought won over **Jalisco Star** at Fontwell and will be suited by the return to this C&D. However, **PEACENIK (nap)** ended last year in good form at around 2m4f and could quite plausibly have untapped potential over 3m.[Chris Wilson]